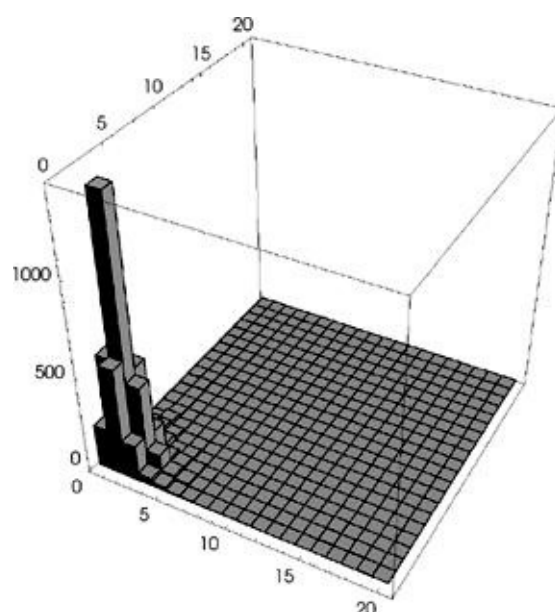


around 1.5. You can extrapolate to estimate that around 34 books will sell more than 500,000 copies—simply 96 times $(500,000/250,000)^{-1.5}$. We can continue, and note that around 12 books should sell more than a million copies, here 96 times $(1,000,000/250,000)^{-1.5}$.

FIGURE 13: THE PURE FRACTAL STATISTICAL MOUNTAIN



The degree of inequality will be the same in all sixteen subsections of the graph. In the Gaussian world, disparities in wealth (or any other quantity) decrease when you look at the upper end—so billionaires should be more equal in relation to one another than millionaires are, and millionaires more equal in relation to one another than the middle class. This lack of equality at all wealth levels, in a nutshell, is statistical self-similarity.

TABLE 2: ASSUMED EXPONENTS FOR VARIOUS PHENOMENA*

<i>Phenomenon</i>	<i>Assumed Exponent (vague approximation)</i>
Frequency of use of words	1.2
Number of hits on websites	1.4
Number of books sold in the U.S.	1.5
Telephone calls received	1.22
Magnitude of earthquakes	2.8
Diameter of moon craters	2.14
Intensity of solar flares	0.8
Intensity of wars	0.8
Net worth of Americans	1.1
Number of persons per family name	1
Population of U.S. cities	1.3
Market moves	3 (or lower)
Company size	1.5
People killed in terrorist attacks	2 (but possibly a much lower exponent)

* Source: M.E.J. Newman (2005) and the author's own calculations.